



Rules of the Wasteland

WELCOME TO ZOMBIE OVERLORD

In Zombie Overlord, you are a Zombie Lord, raising an undead army to ravage what is left of the world.

The only things standing in your way are the other Zombie Lords who think they can devour humanity faster than you can.

But you know better. You are the most ruthless of them all!

Your goal is to build an ever-growing deck of Zombie Minions and unleash them to tear down your rivals.

You will build your deck by purchasing Traps, using them to lure desperate Survivors from the apocalyptic Wasteland to your base. Once they arrive, they will be devoured and converted into new Minions.

Each Survivor is searching for a different type of resource, and you will exploit their desperation by placing the right Traps to pull them in.

Use Supply cards to buy those tempting Traps from the Purchase Row.

*The last player left standing with life points wins the game and become the **Zombie Overlord!***

What's Included in the Box

194 Cards

- 48 Trap Deck Cards
- 68 Survivor Deck Cards
- 20 Action Deck Cards
- 18 Scavenger Deck Cards
- 12 Minion Cards
- 28 Supply Cards

4 Life Point Trackers

4 Life Point Tracker Tokens

Rulebook



SET UP

1. All players start with a Life Point Tracker Card and Token, 7 Supply cards and 3 Minion cards. Shuffle these cards and place them face down in front of you to form your Draw Deck.

Place all unused Supply cards and Minion cards back in the box.

Place a token on the "50" space of your Life Point Tracker to show your starting life points.

Each player draws 5 cards from their Draw Deck. This is their Starting Hand.

2. Shuffle the Trap cards and place them face down on the table.

Remove any Trap cards with a numbered player icon that does not match the number of players in the game.

Draw 5 Trap cards face up to form the Purchase Row.

3. For 2-players games, remove all Survivor cards with the  icon.

Shuffle all remaining Survivors and place the deck face down on the table below the Trap Deck.

Draw 1 Survivor card for each player, plus 1, and place them face up above the Purchase Row. This is the Wasteland.

4. Shuffle the Action cards and place them face down.

5. Place the Scavenger Deck face up.



4 PLAYER SET UP

Player 2 Base

Player 3 Base



Purchase Row

Action Cards



Wasteland



Player 1 Base

Player 4 Base

GAMEPLAY SEQUENCE

A turn always begins with Start Turn, and always ends with Lure, Clean Up, and End Turn (in that order).

The three middle phases: Purchase, Action, and Attack, may be taken in any order.

Start Turn:

Set all inactive Traps you own to active by turning them upright.

Purchase / Action / Attack (Any Order)

You may perform these phases in any order and may return to any of them multiple times during your turn.

Purchase Phase:

Use Supply cards and Scavenger cards from your hand to purchase Trap cards, Action cards, or Scavenger cards.

Action Phase:

Play Trap cards and Action cards from your hand and use active Trap card abilities.

Attack Phase:

Send Minion cards from your hand to attack other players.

You may distribute your Minions however you wish among the other players.

Lure Phase:

Survivors in the Wasteland are lured to the current player if they have the highest corresponding Lure Points.

Clean Up Phase:

Discard all remaining cards from your hand to your Discard pile, then draw 5 cards.

End of Turn:

The current player ends their turn, and the next player may begin.

Player Elimination:

If a player loses all of their Life Points, they are eliminated from the game. Remove all cards they own from play, including cards in their hand, Deck, Discard pile, Trap Cards and any cards they control. Return those cards to the game box.

PURCHASE PHASE

Traps are purchased by playing Supply cards from your hand.

Add up the total number of points from Supply cards in your hand to get your purchase power.

Trap cards display a purchase cost on the top left.

All purchased cards are placed face up in your Discard Pile.

All cards you play during the Purchase Phase go to your Discard Pile

Once a Trap is removed from the Purchase Row, immediately replace it with the next card from the Trap deck.

PURCHASE PHASE EXAMPLE

Player 1 wants to buy a Trap card that costs 5 points. **1** They play 2 Scavenger cards **2** and 1 Supply card **3** for a total of 5.

Player 1 takes the Trap card from the Purchase Row, then moves it to their Discard Pile, along with the Supply and Scavenger cards.



ACTION PHASE

Placing Traps:

- You may have a maximum of 5 Traps in your base.
- Traps are placed from your hand into any open spot in your base and are considered active.
- If you already have 5 Trap cards, you may discard an **Active** Trap to make room for a new one.
- You cannot replace a Trap if you have already used its Ability this turn.

Using Abilities:

- Some Traps have abilities that activate when placed. These must be resolved before placing any additional Traps.
- Traps with *Once Per Turn* abilities are used during the Action Phase.
- Action cards are also played and resolved during the Action Phase.



ATTACK PHASE

Attacking:

Minions are used to attack other players. You may choose to attack any player's life points directly or any Trap card.

A single Minion cannot attack more than 1 target, but Minions can be grouped together to increase the attack points inflicted on a single target.

Destroying:

You may target another player's Trap cards to either destroy or deactivate them.

To destroy a Trap, you must have Attack Points equal to or greater than the Trap's Defense Points.

The larger white number on the bottom right of a Trap card is the attack needed to destroy it.

You can combine Minions to attack a single Trap card.

Destroyed Traps are placed in the owner's Discard Pile.



ATTACK EXAMPLE

Player 1 is attacking Player 2's base with 3 Zombie Minions.

Player 2 has 2 active Traps.

Player 1 uses their Zombie 'Sergeant' **1** to destroy one Trap card, **2** and then uses their Zombie 'Mechanic' and 'Ice Cream Man' to attack Player 2's Life Points directly.

Player 2 must move their Medicine Trap to their Discard Pile and subtract 7 Life Points from their Life Point Tracker.



ATTACK PHASE

Deactivating Traps: To deactivate a Trap, you must have Attack Points equal or greater than the smaller red number on the bottom right of the card. The Trap is rotated sideways to indicate it is inactive. It remains inactive until the start of the owner's turn.

Inactive Traps are ignored during the Lure phase.
You cannot play a Trap card's abilities while it is inactive.



The purpose of destroying or deactivating other player's Traps is to ensure that you will gain more Survivors during the Lure phase.

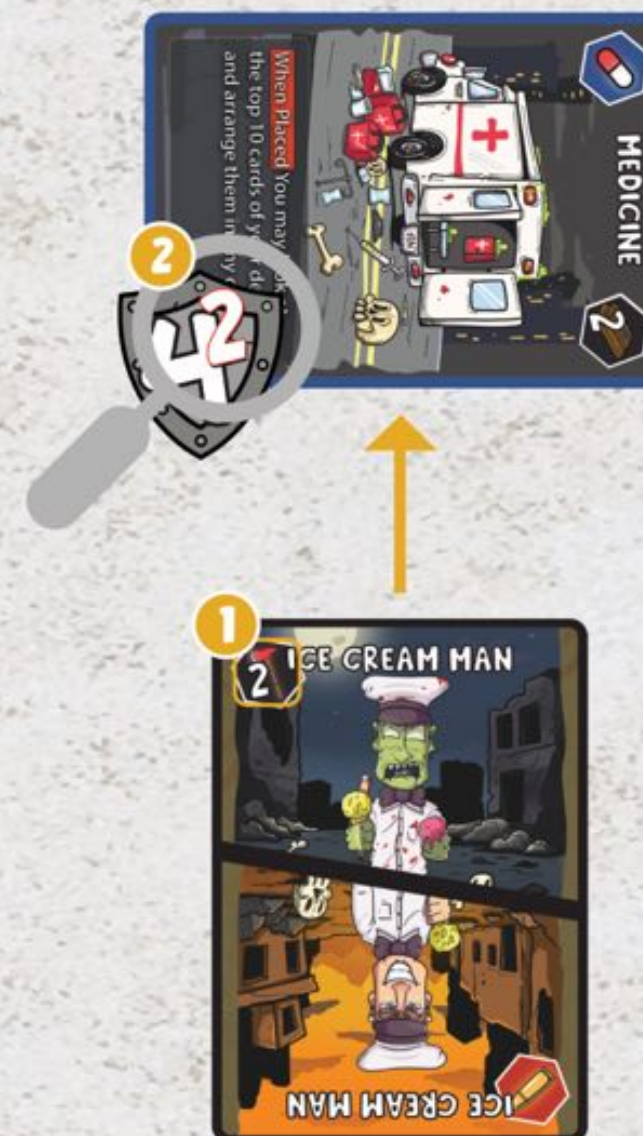
DEACTIVATE EXAMPLE

Player 1 is attacking player 2's base with 1 Zombie Minion.

Instead of attacking player 2's Life Points directly, they target one of player 2's Traps.

The Zombie 'Ice Cream Man' has 2 Attack **1** so it can successfully deactivate the Medicine Trap which has 4(2) Defense. **2**

Player 2 rotates their Trap sideways to show that it will be ignored during Lure Phase.



Barricade Ability:

Traps with the "Barricade" ability act as protection to the player's Life Points. Players must destroy all Traps with this ability before attacking the owner's Life Points.

Barricade Traps do not protect other Trap cards from being attacked first.

LURE PHASE

All players add up their matching Lure Points for their active Traps. Each Trap counts as 1 Lure Point.

- If the current player has the highest matching Lure Type for one or more Survivors in the Wasteland, they lure those Survivors and place them into their Discard Pile.
- Only the current player can lure Survivors during the Lure Phase.
- If there is a tie for highest Lure Points, that Survivor remains in the Wasteland.

Survivors with two Lure types are lured only if the current player has the highest combined total of both Lure types.

Once no additional Survivors can be lured, replace all Survivors that were lured, which ends the Lure Phase.

Survivors lured before the Lure Phase (through Action cards or Trap abilities) are not replaced until the end of the Lure Phase.

LURE EXAMPLE

It's Player 1's turn, so only they can lure Survivors, but all active Lure cards are counted.

Player 1's base: 2 Fuel Traps **1**

Player 2's base: 1 Fuel Trap, **2** 1 Ammo Trap.

The 'Contractor' **3** is lured because Player 1 has more Fuel Lure points than Player 2.

Even though Player 2 has both Fuel and Ammo Lure points to Lure the 'Point Guard' and 'Arsonist', it is not their turn, so both Survivors remain the Wasteland.



CLEAN UP PHASE

Discard all remaining cards from your hand into your Discard Pile, then draw 5 new cards.

If you run out of cards in your Draw Deck while drawing, shuffle your Discard Pile and place it face-down to form a new Draw Deck. Continue drawing until you have a full hand of 5 cards.

Clean Up Phase Example:

After discarding the cards from your hand, you have 2 cards left in your Draw Deck.

Draw those 2 cards, then shuffle your Discard Pile to form a new Draw Deck and draw 3 more cards to reach a hand of 5.



TRAP CARDS

- A Resource Type:** Shows which type of Survivor this Trap lures.
- B Cost:** The number of Supply Points needed to acquire this card.
- C Defense:** The amount of Attack Points needed to destroy this Trap. The smaller red number indicates how many Attack Points are needed deactivate it.
*Inactive Traps still require full Defense (larger white number) to be destroyed.

- D Ability:** The special ability this Trap provides:

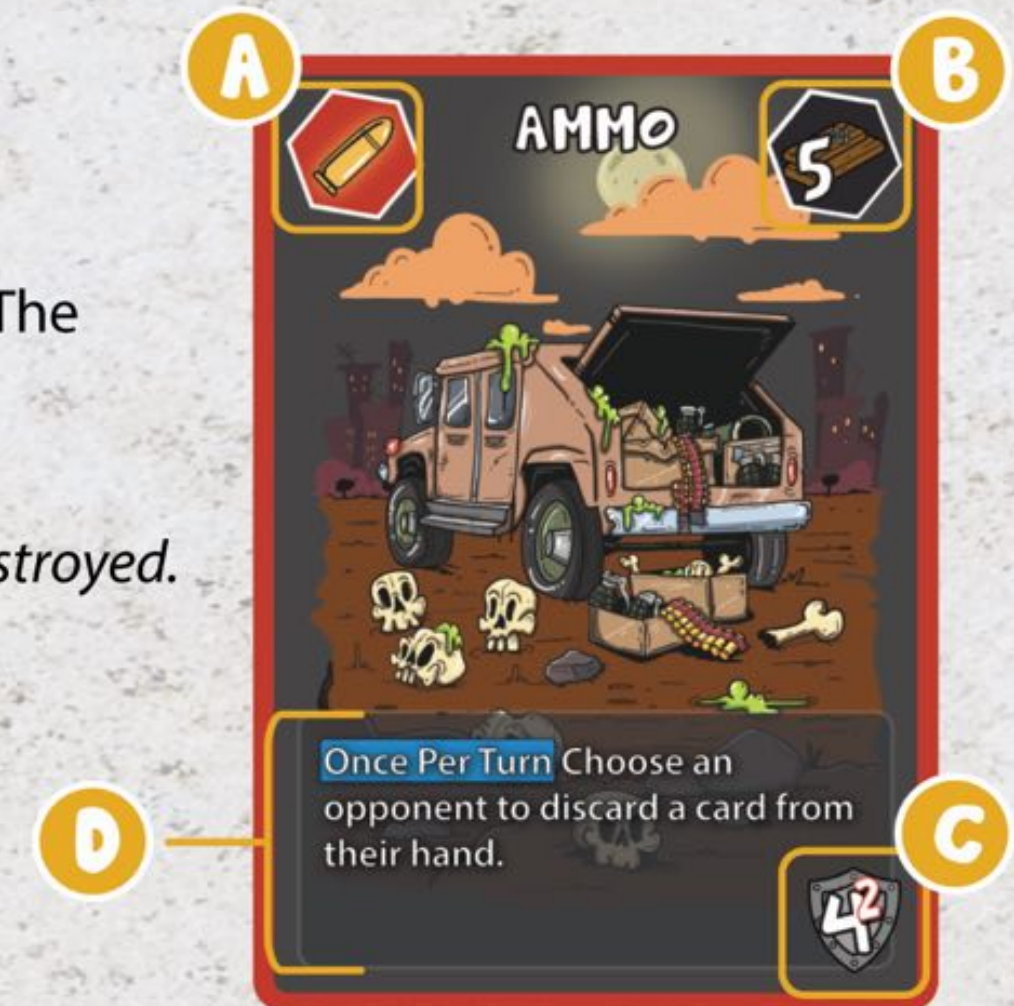
Once Per Turn This means the ability can be used once every turn.

When Placed This means the ability can only be used every time it is placed from the owner's hand.

Combo This means the ability can be used once every turn if the owner has another active Trap of the same type.

- E Barricade** Barricade: Protects your Life Points (even while inactive).
Opponents must destroy all Barricades before attacking your Life Points.
Does not protect other Traps.

- F Player Count Icons:** Trap cards with a numbered player icon are only used when playing with that number of players.



SURVIVOR/MINION CARDS

Survivor cards are the primary source of your Minion army.

When a Survivor is lured to your base, it is converted into a Minion card and added to your Discard pile.

When playing a Minion card, flip it so the Zombie character is on top.

After attacking with a Minion, place it in your discard pile.

A Lure Type: Shows which Lure type(s) attract this Survivor.

B Attack: Shows how many Attack Points this card provides once it becomes a Minion.

C Dual Lure Type: Some Survivors have 2 Lure types. To lure them, the current player must have the highest combined total of both Lure types in their base.

D 3-4 Player Icon: Survivors with this icon should only be included when playing with 3–4 players.

**There are a total of 12 Survivor cards with this icon.*



ACTION CARDS

Action cards may be purchased for 2 Supply Points and are placed in your Discard Pile when purchased.

They may be used during the Action Phase.

After using an Action card, place it in your discard pile.

If you choose not to play an Action card during your turn, add it to your Discard Pile during the Clean Up Phase.

A **Ability:** Describes the effect of the Action card when it is played.



MINION CARDS

Minion cards are part of your starting Draw Deck.

When played, they are used to attack other players during the Attack Phase.

A **Attack:** Minion cards provide 1 Attack Point.



SUPPLY CARDS

Supply cards are part of your starting Draw Deck.

When played during the Purchase Phase, they are used to acquire Traps, Actions, and Scavenger cards.

A *Supply Points:* Supply cards always provide 1 Purchase Point.



SCAVENGER CARDS

Scavenger cards may be purchased for 2 Supply Points and then placed face up in the Discard Pile.

They are played the same as the Supply cards, except they provide more Supply Points.

When played during the Purchase Phase, they are used to acquire Traps, Actions, and Scavenger cards.

A Cost: The number of Supply Points needed to acquire this card.

B Supply Points: Scavenger cards always provide 2 Purchase Points.

Additional Effect: Scavenger Cards may be banished to deal 2 Attack Points.



GLOSSARY

Active Trap:

A Trap that is upright and able to use its abilities. Active Traps also contribute their Lure Points during the Lure Phase.

Banish:

When a card is banished, it is placed in the Banish Pile. Banished cards are permanently removed from the game and cannot return.

Base:

The area in front of a player where their active and inactive Trap cards are placed.

Converted:

When a Survivor is successfully lured, it becomes a Minion card. Converted Survivors are flipped so the Minion side (with attack strength) is on top.

Destroy:

When a Trap is destroyed, it is placed face up in its owner's discard pile.

Discard:

When a card is discarded, it is placed face up into its owner's Discard Pile.

Lured:

When a player has the highest matching Lure type for a Survivor in the Wasteland and takes that Survivor, converting it into a Minion card and placing it face up in their discard pile.

Purchase Points:

The total number of Supply Points provided by Supply and Scavenger cards a player plays during the Purchase Phase.

Random Card:

To draw a random card from a hand, the player shuffles their hand and selects one card at random.

Lure Type / Lure Points:

A Lure Type is shown on Survivors (top left icon) and on Trap cards (top left and bottom right colored corners).

There are four Lure Types: Ammo, Fuel, Food, and Medicine.

Lure Types are used during the Lure Phase to determine which Survivors the current player attracts.

Empty Decks:

If the Trap Deck or Survivor Deck runs out, players continue playing normally. No additional Trap cards or Survivors are added once these decks are empty.

CREDITS

Game Design & Development

Erick Quintanilla

Artwork

Maximiliano Musso (AKA Chino The Goat)

Special Thanks

Megan Quintanilla

Andres Luna

David Quintanilla

Andrew Smith

Gabe Cruz

Overlords

Founding supporters who helped bring Zombie Overlord to life.

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|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| •Alex Kian | •José miguel Narciso Marques |
| •Dave and Deanne Fisher | •Keith Ono |
| •Dory Alvarenga | •Mathew Pannell |
| •Emanuel Fuentes | •Matt Goodwin |
| •Jacob Simper | •Michael Bryant |
| •Jameson Miller | •Norman E Wirth |
| | •Tahnee Copeland |



Created By Erick Quintanilla
Illustrated by Chino The Goat



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